

I SURVIVED WHAT WAS SUPPOSED TO ERASE ME

Truth always wins. It just needs time.

And time has passed.

I survived what was supposed to erase me.

What followed was not merely hardship. It was an attempt to erase a person through isolation, humiliation, poverty, institutional indifference, damaged reputation and the relentless suggestion that the victim must somehow be responsible for what happened to him.

But I am still here.

My silence was never surrender.

My silence became evidence.

My silence became forensic.

My survival became the thing that could not be administratively erased.

I have made serious allegations about what happened to me, including allegations concerning an attempt on my life. Those allegations are my testimony and interpretation of the evidence. I do not need to manufacture certainty where the evidence is contested. I need only preserve the record and insist that the allegations be properly examined.

That is what I have done.

I have published my account.

I have preserved the documents.

I have placed the allegations alongside the official records from the governments and institutions involved.

And now the story exists outside of me.

That changes everything.

For years, people could dismiss me as unstable, immoral, difficult, unwell or simply inconvenient.

They could reduce a complex history to a diagnosis or a character judgment.

But a person is not disproved by being psychologically vulnerable.

A diagnosis does not automatically invalidate testimony.

Poverty does not invalidate evidence.

Homelessness does not invalidate facts.

Humiliation does not make an accusation false.

And suffering does not remove a person's right to be heard.

I refuse to accept the idea that the answer to uncomfortable evidence is to destroy the credibility of the person presenting it.

If my allegations are wrong, they can be examined.

If my evidence is wrong, it can be disproved.

If my interpretation is wrong, it can be challenged.

But none of those things can be accomplished merely by attacking my character.

I have accused people close to me of profoundly serious wrongdoing.

I have accused institutions of failing to protect me.

I have questioned decisions that affected my liberty, housing, finances, health and ability to obtain justice.

I have described experiences that I believe amount to an attempt to remove me from ordinary life.

These are not small accusations.

And because they are serious, they deserve something more serious than silence.

They deserve examination.

I have spent years being treated as though my greatest crime was refusing to disappear.

Perhaps that is what people find most difficult about me now.

I no longer require their validation.

I no longer need permission to tell my story.

I no longer need to make myself smaller so that other people can remain comfortable.

I no longer accept that I must remain beneath those who have already decided that I belong there.

I was whole before their approval.

I remain whole without it.

My faith has become the place where I locate that wholeness.

I understand my survival through the language of resurrection: not as proof that I am literally a resurrected biblical figure, but as the deepest metaphor I have for what happened to me.

Something in me was supposed to end.

It did not.

I survived.

And survival changed me.

The person who emerged from that experience is not the person who entered it.

I have learned that dependence on people who continually diminish you is not the same thing as love.

I have learned that family does not automatically mean safety.

I have learned that institutions can fail.

I have learned that reputation can be weaponised.

I have learned that mental illness can be used, deliberately or otherwise, to make a person's testimony easier to disregard.

And I have learned something even more important:

I do not have to disappear simply because other people would prefer that I did.

My family's conduct, like everyone else's, should ultimately be judged by evidence rather than by my accusation alone.

I will not pretend certainty about another person's private intentions merely because I believe the pattern is obvious.

But neither will I withdraw an allegation simply because it makes people uncomfortable.

If I believe I was abandoned, exploited, targeted or endangered, I am entitled to document why.

If I believe decisions were made that contributed to my exclusion, poverty or institutional vulnerability, I am entitled to identify those decisions.

If I believe my evidence has been ignored, I am entitled to keep placing it on the record.

That is not an attack.

It is accountability.

I am not seeking revenge.

I am seeking recognition of reality.

I am not trying to destroy anyone.

I am refusing to participate in my own destruction.

There is a difference.

I believe I was repeatedly framed through the lens of my vulnerabilities rather than understood through the totality of my evidence.

The accusation becomes:

What's wrong with him?

Instead of:

What happened to him?

The question should never be whether I am sufficiently perfect to deserve justice.

No human being has to be perfect to deserve protection.

No human being has to be healthy to deserve dignity.

No human being has to be believed immediately to deserve investigation.

And no human being should have to become silent to make other people comfortable.

I have spent years watching people attempt to rewrite the narrative around me.

But the record remains.

The documents remain.

The memories remain.

The testimony remains.

The archive remains.

And I remain.

That is the part they underestimated.

They thought survival would make me weaker.

Instead, survival taught me who I was without them.

They thought isolation would make me disappear.

Instead, isolation forced me to discover that I could stand alone.

They thought humiliation would destroy my identity.

Instead, it stripped away the identities other people had imposed upon me.

They thought my greatest vulnerability was that I needed their approval.

They were wrong.

I don't.

I am not claiming perfection.

I am claiming existence.

I am claiming the right to tell the truth as I understand it.

I am claiming the right to preserve evidence.

I am claiming the right to ask questions.

I am claiming the right to demand that serious allegations be examined rather than buried beneath character assassination.

And I am claiming the right to become someone beyond the version of me that other people found easier to control.

I was rising while they were trying to keep me beneath them.

They underestimated how much a person can change after losing everything.

They underestimated what happens when someone finally stops asking permission to exist.

They underestimated the person I am becoming.

And perhaps the greatest irony is this:

They thought erasing me would end the story.

It created the archive.

It created the testimony.

It created the evidence.

It created the witness.

It created the man who no longer needs their permission to speak.

I survived what was supposed to erase me.

Now the record survives with me.

And I will not shrink simply because the truth is inconvenient.

My silence is forensic.

My survival is undeniable.

My testimony remains.

And history can decide what the evidence means.